“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 18

Beholding Śrī Vṛndāvana

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 Delighting the moving and nonmoving beings of Vṛndāvana with His glances, and Himself rejoicing at the sight of them, Gaurāṅga wandered everywhere.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

3 Dancing and dancing in this way, Mahāprabhu came to Āriṭ-grāma, and there His outer awareness suddenly returned.

4 In Ariṣṭa He asked the people about Rādhā-kuṇḍa, but no one could tell Him, and the brāhmaṇa with Him did not know either.

5 The Lord, the all-knowing Bhagavān, knew that the holy place had been lost to sight, and He bathed in the shallow water of two rice fields.[2]

6 Seeing this, all the villagers were astonished. Then, full of love, the Lord praised Rādhā-kuṇḍa:

7 Of all the gopīs, Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa’s dearest. So too Rādhā-kuṇḍa is dear to Him: it is the lake of His beloved.

8 “As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is Her pond dear to Him; among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved.” (Padma Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45)[3]

9 In this kuṇḍa Kṛṣṇa eternally sports with Rādhikā in the water, and on its bank He delights in the rāsa dance.

10 To anyone who bathes in that kuṇḍa even once, Kṛṣṇa gives love like Rādhā’s own.

11 The sweetness of the kuṇḍa is like Rādhā’s own charm, and the glory of the kuṇḍa is like Rādhā’s own glory.

12 “By its own wondrous qualities Her lake is as dear to Hari as Śrī Rādhā Herself. In it the beautiful moon Mādhava ceaselessly sports with Her in love, and whoever bathes in it even once gains love for Him like Rādhikā’s. Who on earth could describe its glory and its sweetness?” (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 7.102)

13 Absorbed in love, He offered these praises, and He danced on the bank, remembering the pastimes of the kuṇḍa.

14 He took clay from the kuṇḍa and marked Himself with tilaka, and He had the Bhaṭṭācārya carry some of the clay along.

15 Then the Lord went on to Sumanaḥ-sarovara. There He saw Govardhana and was overwhelmed.[4]

16 Seeing Govardhana, the Lord fell down like a rod in obeisance. He embraced a rock of Govardhana and became mad with love.

17 Intoxicated with love, He went on to the village of Govardhana. There He saw Harideva and bowed down before Him.

18 Harideva, who dwells on the western petal of the lotus of Mathurā, is Nārāyaṇa, the original manifestation.

19 Before Harideva He danced, intoxicated with love, and all the people, hearing of the wonder, came to see.

20 The people were amazed to see the Lord's love and beauty, and the servant of Harideva received the Lord with honour.

21 The Bhaṭṭācārya went to Brahma-kuṇḍa and cooked there, and the Lord bathed in Brahma-kuṇḍa and took His meal.

22 He spent that night in the temple of Harideva, and during the night Mahāprabhu reflected:

23 "I shall never climb Govardhana. How, then, shall I have darśana of Gopāla-rāya?"

24 Thinking this, the Lord kept silent. Gopāla knew His mind and raised a pretext: fear of the mlecchas.

25 Gaura regarded Himself as a devotee and would not climb the hill; so Kṛṣṇa came down from the hill and showed Himself to Gaura — to His very own Self.[5]

26 Gopāla resided in the village called Annakūṭa, and the people of that village were Rajputs.

27 One night a man came and told the villagers: "Turkish troops have armed themselves to raid your village.

28 Flee tonight, and let not a single person remain. Take the Deity and run, for the yavanas will come tomorrow."

29 Hearing this, the villagers grew anxious. First of all they took Gopāla and placed Him in the village of Gāṭholi.

30 In a brāhmaṇa's house Gopāla was served in secret. The village was deserted, for everyone had fled.

31 In this way, for fear of the mlecchas, Gopāla flees again and again: He leaves His temple and stays in a grove or in another village.

32 In the morning the Lord bathed in Mānasa-gaṅgā and set out to circle Govardhana.

33 Seeing Govardhana, the Lord was overcome with love, and He went on, dancing and dancing and reciting this verse:

34 "Ah, friends, this hill is the best of Hari's servants! Thrilled by the touch of the feet of Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, it honours Them, together with Their cows and companions, with water to drink, fine grass, caves, and bulbs and roots." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.18)[6]

35 The Lord bathed at Govinda-kuṇḍa and other holy places, and there He heard that Gopāla was in the village of Gāṭholi.

36 He went to that village and had darśana of Gopāla, and in the rapture of love the Lord sang and danced.

37 Seeing the beauty of Gopāla, the Lord was enraptured. Reciting this verse, He danced until the day was over:

38 "May the left arm of the lotus-eyed Lord protect you — the arm with which He made Govardhana Hill a ball for His play." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, Vibhāva-laharī, 26)[7]

39 In this way He beheld Gopāla for three days, and on the fourth day Gopāla went back to His own temple.

40 He went along with Gopāla, dancing and singing, and in a joyful uproar the people cried, “Hari! Hari!”

41 Gopāla went to His temple, and the Lord remained below. Gopāla had fulfilled all the Lord’s desires.

42 Such is Gopāla’s compassionate nature. The hearts of His devotees long for the sight of Him.

43 Yet, eager as they are, they will not climb Govardhana, and so, on some pretext, Gopāla Himself comes down to them.[8]

44 Sometimes He stays in a grove, sometimes in another village, and any devotee may come there and see Him.

45 The two brothers, Rūpa and Sanātana, would not climb the hill, and in this way He gave them darśana.

46 In his old age Rūpa Gosāñi could no longer go there, yet a desire arose in him to see the beauty of Gopāla.

47 For fear of the mlecchas Gopāla came to the city of Mathurā and stayed for a month in the house of Viṭhṭhaleśvara.[9]

48 Then Rūpa Gosāñi took all his associates with him, stayed in Mathurā for a month and had darśana of Gopāla.

49 With him were Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Raghunātha dāsa, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosāñi and Lokanātha,

50 Bhūgarbha Gosāñi, Śrī Jīva Gosāñi, Śrī Yādava Ācārya, Govinda Gosāñi,

51 Śrī Uddhava dāsa and Mādhava, Śrī Gopāla dāsa and Nārāyaṇa dāsa,

52 the devotee Govinda, Vāṇī Kṛṣṇadāsa, Puṇḍarīkākṣa, Īśāna and Laghu Haridāsa.[10]

53 Taking all these chief devotees with him, he had darśana of Śrī Gopāla with great joy.

54 After staying for a month, Gopāla went back to His own place, and Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi returned to Śrī Vṛndāvana.

55 In passing I have told the story of Gopāla's mercy. Then Mahāprabhu went to Śrī Kāmyavana.

56 In the same way as I described before, the Lord travelled through Vṛndāvana and saw all its holy places.

57 After seeing the places of the pastimes there, He went to Nandīśvara, and on seeing Nandīśvara He was overwhelmed with love.

58 He bathed in all the kuṇḍas, beginning with Pāvana, and then He went up the hill and asked the people:

59 "Are there any Deities on the hill?" The people said, "There are Deities inside a cave.

60 On either side are the mother and father, sturdy of build, and between them is a child, beautiful in His threefold bending form."[11]

61 Mahāprabhu was delighted to hear this. He opened the cave and saw the three Deities.

62 He bowed to the feet of the King and Queen of Vraja, and in the rapture of love He touched Kṛṣṇa's whole body.

63 All day He danced and sang, absorbed in love, and from there Mahāprabhu came to Khadiravana.

64 He saw the places of the pastimes there and went on to Śeṣaśāyī. There, seeing Lakṣmī, the Lord recited this verse:

65 "O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)[12]

66 Then, after seeing Khelā-tīrtha, He came to Bhāṇḍīravana, and crossing the Yamunā He went to Bhadravana.

67 From Śrīvana He went on to Lohavana, and in Mahāvana He saw the place of Kṛṣṇa's birth.

68 He saw the places where the twin Arjuna trees were broken and where other pastimes took place, and the Lord's heart trembled with love.

69 From Gokula He came to the city of Mathurā. He saw the place of Kṛṣṇa's birth and stayed in the house of that same brāhmaṇa.[13]

70 Seeing the crowds of people, He left Mathurā and came to stay in solitude at Akrūra-tīrtha.

71 The next day the Lord came to see Vṛndāvana, and He bathed in Kālīya-hrada and in Praskandana.

72 From Dvādaśāditya He came to Keśī-tīrtha, and on seeing the place of the rāsa dance He fainted with love.

73 Regaining consciousness, He rolled on the ground again; He laughed, wept, danced, fell down and sang at the top of His voice.

74 He spent that day there in this joy, and in the evening He returned to Akrūra and took His meal.

75 In the morning He bathed at Cīra-ghāṭa in Vṛndāvana, and then He came to Tẽtula-talā and rested there.[14]

76 That ancient tree dates from the time of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, and beneath it is a raised platform, beautifully smooth.

77 The Yamunā flows nearby, and a cool breeze blows. He gazed at the beauty of Vṛndāvana and at the waters of the Yamunā.

78 Sitting beneath the tamarind tree, He performed saṅkīrtana of the holy name, and after His midday duties He would return to Akrūra for His meal.

79 The people of Akrūra would come to see the Lord, and in the crowd He could not perform kīrtana freely.

80 So the Lord would come to Vṛndāvana, sit in solitude and perform saṅkīrtana of the holy name until midday.

81 In the third watch of the day people would have His darśana, and He taught everyone the saṅkīrtana of the holy name.[15]

82 At that time a Vaiṣṇava named Kṛṣṇadāsa came. He was a Rajput by birth and a householder, and his village was across the Yamunā.

83 After bathing at Keśī-tīrtha, he was on his way to Kālīya-daha when he suddenly saw the Lord at Āmli-talā.

84 Seeing the Lord's beauty and love, he was amazed, and in the rapture of love he bowed down to the Lord.

85 The Lord asked, "Who are you? Where is your home?" Kṛṣṇadāsa said, "I am a wretched householder.

86 I am a Rajput by birth, and my home is on the other bank. My desire is to become a servant of the Vaiṣṇavas.

87 But today I had a dream, and now it has come true before my eyes: I have come here and found You."[16]

88 The Lord showed him mercy and embraced him. Kṛṣṇadāsa became intoxicated with love; he danced and cried, "Hari!"

89 At midday he came with the Lord to Akrūra-tīrtha and received the prasāda left on the Lord's plate.

90 The next morning he came with the Lord, carrying His waterpot. Leaving home, wife and son, he stayed with the Lord.

91 Everywhere people began to say, "Kṛṣṇa has appeared again in Vṛndāvana!"

92 One day, early in the morning, people came from Vṛndāvana to Akrūra, making a great uproar.

93 Seeing the Lord, the people bowed to His feet. The Lord asked, “Where have you come from?”

94 The people said, “Kṛṣṇa has appeared in the waters of Kālīya’s lake! He dances on Kālīya’s heads, and the jewels on the serpent’s hoods are blazing.

95 People have seen Him with their own eyes; there is no doubt about it.” Hearing this, the Lord laughed and said, “It is all true.”

96 In this way people went there for three nights, and they all came back saying, “We have had darśana of Kṛṣṇa.”

97 Before the Lord the people said, “We have seen Śrī Kṛṣṇa!” Through these words Sarasvatī made them speak the truth.

98 In seeing Mahāprabhu they truly had darśana of Kṛṣṇa; but through their own ignorance they set the truth aside and mistook the untrue for the true.

99 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya said at the Lord’s feet, “Give me permission, and I shall go and have darśana of Kṛṣṇa!”

100 At this the Lord gave him a slap and said, “You are a learned man, yet you have become a fool by listening to the words of fools.

101 Why would Kṛṣṇa give darśana in the age of Kali? Foolish people are making an uproar out of their own delusion.

102 Do not go mad. Stay at home and sit quietly. You can go tomorrow night and have darśana of Kṛṣṇa.”

103 In the morning some respectable people came to the Lord, and the Lord asked them, “Have you come from seeing Kṛṣṇa?”

104 They said, “At night a fisherman gets into a boat, lights a torch and catches fish in Kālīya’s lake.

105 Seeing this from a distance, people are deluded: ‘Kṛṣṇa is dancing on Kālīya’s body!’

106 They take the boat for Kālīya and the lamp for his jewels, and these foolish people regard the fisherman as Kṛṣṇa!”

107 That Kṛṣṇa had come to Vṛndāvana was also true, and that the people had seen Kṛṣṇa was not false.

108 But some saw Kṛṣṇa, while others were deceived, as one mistakes a bare tree trunk for a man.[17]

109 The Lord asked, “Then where have you had darśana of Kṛṣṇa?” The people said, “You are a sannyāsī, a moving Nārāyaṇa.

110 In Vṛndāvana You have become an avatāra of Kṛṣṇa, and by seeing You everyone has been delivered.”

111 The Lord said, “Viṣṇu! Viṣṇu! Do not say such a thing! Never take a lowly jīva for Kṛṣṇa![18]

112 A sannyāsī is a jīva, a tiny particle of spirit, like a speck of sunlight; but Kṛṣṇa, full of the six opulences, is like the sun itself.

113 The jīva and the Lord are never equal, just as a tiny spark is never equal to a great blazing fire.

114 “The Lord, embraced by the hlādinī and saṁvit potencies, is eternal being, consciousness and bliss; the jīva, covered by its own ignorance, is a

mine of countless miseries." (words of Viṣṇusvāmī quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.5–6)[19]

115 The fool who says that the jīva is 'equal' to the Lord is godless (*pāṣaṇḍī*), and Yama punishes him.[20]

116 'One who looks upon the Lord Nārāyaṇa as equal to Brahmā, Rudra and the other gods is surely a *pāṣaṇḍī*.'" (Vaiṣṇava-tantra)

117 The people said, "We never think of You as a jīva. Your form and nature are like Kṛṣṇa's.

118 By Your features we see that You are the son of the king of Vraja; only the lustre of Your body covers You like a yellow garment.

119 Musk may be tied up in cloth, yet it does not stay hidden; just so, Your nature as the Lord cannot be concealed.

120 Your nature is extraordinary, beyond the reach of the intellect. Seeing You, the world goes mad with love for Kṛṣṇa.

121–122 Women, children and old men, even caṇḍālas and yavanas — whoever sees You even once takes the name of Kṛṣṇa and dances as if mad. He becomes an ācārya and delivers the world.

123 Let alone seeing You — whoever only hears Your name becomes mad with love for Kṛṣṇa and delivers the three worlds.

124 Hearing Your name, even a dog-eater becomes a purifier of others. Your extraordinary power cannot be described.

125 "O Lord, if even a dog-eater hears and chants Your name, bows down to You or remembers You but once, he is instantly made fit to perform

Vedic sacrifice. How much more, then, one who sees You!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.33.6)[21]

126 Such glories are Your indirect characteristics (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*); in Your essential nature You are the son of the king of Vraja."[22]

127 The Lord showed mercy to all those people, and, intoxicated with love for Kṛṣṇa, they went back to their homes.

128 In this way He stayed some days at Akrūra, delivering the people by giving them the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him.[23]

129 That brāhmaṇa, the disciple of Mādhava Purī, arranged invitations for the Lord in house after house in Mathurā.

130 All the people of Mathurā — brāhmaṇas and respectable folk — came to the Bhaṭṭācārya to invite the Lord.

131 In a single day ten or twenty invitations would come, but the Bhaṭṭācārya would accept only one.

132 People could not find a chance to give their invitations, so they pleaded with that brāhmaṇa to have them accepted.

133 Vedic brāhmaṇas of Kānyakubja and of the south humbly invited Mahāprabhu.

134 They would come to Akrūra in the morning and cook, and after offering the food to the śālagrāma they would give it to the Lord as His meal.

135 One day Mahāprabhu sat at that Akrūra-ghāṭa and reflected:

136 “At this ghāṭa Akrūra saw Vaikuṇṭha, and the people of Vraja had a vision of Goloka.”

137 With these words He leapt into the water and stayed submerged beneath it.

138 Seeing this, Kṛṣṇadāsa wept and cried out, and the Bhaṭṭācārya quickly came and pulled the Lord out.

139 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya took that brāhmaṇa aside, and sitting in a secluded place they made a plan.

140 “Today I was here, and I pulled the Lord out. But if He dives in at Vṛndāvana, who will pull Him out?

141 The crowds of people, the bother of invitations, the Lord’s constant absorption — none of this seems good to me.

142 If we take the Lord away from Vṛndāvana, all will be well. This is a good plan.”

143 The brāhmaṇa said, “Let us take the Lord to Prayāga. If we go by the road along the bank of the Gaṅgā, the journey will be pleasant.

144 Let us first go to Soro-kṣetra and bathe in the Gaṅgā, and then travel on that road with the Lord.

145 The month of Māgha has begun. If we go now, we shall have some days of bathing at Prayāga during Makara.

146 Tell Him something of your own distress, and mention the full moon of Makara (*makara-pañcasi*) at Prayāga.[24]

147 Tell Him too how pleasant the road along the Gaṅgā is.” Then the Bhaṭṭācārya came and spoke to the Lord:

148 “I cannot bear the commotion of these people. They jostle one another to invite You.

149 People come in the morning and do not find You; and when they do not find You, they pester me to death.

150 I would be happy if we went by the road along the Gaṅgā. If we go now, we shall be able to bathe in the Gaṅgā during Makara.

151 My heart is troubled; I cannot bear it. I shall bow my head to whatever the Lord commands.”

152 Although the Lord had no wish to leave Vṛndāvana, to fulfil His devotee’s wish He spoke sweet words:

153 “You brought Me here and showed Me Vṛndāvana. I shall never be able to repay this debt.

154 Whatever you wish, that I will do. Wherever you take Me, there I will go.”

155 In the morning Mahāprabhu bathed, and at the thought “I am leaving Vṛndāvana” He was overwhelmed with love.

156 There were no outward transformations, but His heart was absorbed in love. The Bhaṭṭācārya said, “Come, let us go to Mahāvana.”[25]

157 Saying this, the Bhaṭṭācārya seated Mahāprabhu in a boat, took Him across the river and set off with Him.

158 Kṛṣṇadāsa, full of love, and that brāhmaṇa — these two knew the road along the Gaṅgā well.

159 On the way the Lord saw that everyone was tired from walking, and He sat down with them all beneath a tree.

160 Many cows were grazing near that tree, and the sight of them filled Mahāprabhu's heart with joy.

161 Suddenly a cowherd played on his flute, and hearing it, Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with great love.

162 The Lord fell unconscious to the ground; foam came from His mouth, and the breath in His nostrils stopped.

163 Just then ten horsemen arrived there — mleccha Paṭhāns — and dismounted from their horses.

164 Seeing the Lord, the mlecchas reasoned: "This sannyāsī had boundless gold.

165 These four highwaymen drugged him with datura, killed him and took all the sannyāsī's wealth."[26]

166 Then the Paṭhāns bound the four men and wanted to cut them down. The Bengalis all began to tremble.

167 Kṛṣṇadāsa was a Rajput and utterly fearless. That brāhmaṇa too was fearless, and very bold of speech.

168 The brāhmaṇa said, "Paṭhān, I appeal to you in the name of your pādśāh! Come along — I will go with you before the sikdār.[27]

169 This sannyāsī is my guru, and I am a brāhmaṇa of Mathurā. I have a hundred men at the pādśāh's court.

170 Because of an illness this sannyāsī sometimes faints. He will soon regain consciousness and come to His senses.

171 Sit here a moment and keep us all bound. Ask Him, and then kill me."

172 The Paṭhān said, "You two are men of the west, from Mathurā, and these two Bengali cheats are trembling."[28]

173 Kṛṣṇadāsa said, "My home is in this village. There are two hundred Turks there and a hundred guns.

174 If I give the signal, they will all come at once, kill you all and carry off your horses and saddles.[29]

175 The Bengalis are not highwaymen — you are the highwaymen! You rob pilgrims and want to kill them besides."

176 Hearing this, the Paṭhāns began to hesitate. Just then Mahāprabhu regained consciousness.

177 He rose with a loud roar, calling "Hari! Hari!", and absorbed in love He danced with His arms raised high.

178 When the Lord, absorbed in love, cried out, it pierced the mlecchas' hearts like the point of a spear.

179 Frightened, the mlecchas set the four men free, and the Lord did not see His companions in bonds.[30]

180 The Bhaṭṭācārya came, took hold of the Lord and seated Him. Seeing the mlecchas, Mahāprabhu returned to outward consciousness.

181 The mlecchas came and bowed at the Lord's feet, and before Him they said, "These four men are cheats.

182 These four together drugged You with datura, made You lose Your senses and took Your wealth."

183 The Lord said, "They are not cheats; they are My companions. I am a mendicant sannyāsī and have no wealth at all.

184 Because of the falling sickness I sometimes lose consciousness, and these four kindly look after Me."

185 Among those mlecchas was one very grave man. He wore black clothes, and people called him a *pīr*.[31]

186 His heart melted when he saw the Lord, and, citing his own scripture, he set out to establish the impersonal (*nirviśeṣa*) Brahman.

187 He set forth the doctrine of the non-dual Brahman, and the Lord refuted him with the reasoning of his own scripture.

188 Whatever he said, the Lord refuted it all. No answer came to his lips, and he was struck utterly dumb.

189 The Lord said, "Your scripture establishes the impersonal, but in the end it refutes that and establishes the personal (*saviśeṣa*).

190 At the end your scripture speaks of 'one God alone', 'full of all majesty', whose form is dark.

191 His body is eternity, knowledge and bliss; He is the complete Brahman in person. He is ‘the Soul of all’ and ‘the Knower of all’, the eternal origin of all.

192 Creation, maintenance and dissolution come from Him; He is the shelter of the gross and subtle worlds.

193 He is ‘the highest of all, to be worshipped by all, the cause of all causes’. By devotion to Him the jīva is delivered from saṁsāra.

194 Without serving Him, the jīva is never free of saṁsāra. Love for His feet is ‘the essence of all human goals’.

195 The joy of liberation and the like is not a particle of that bliss: to serve His feet is to attain complete bliss.

196 First it establishes karma, jñāna and yoga, but then it refutes them all and establishes ‘God’ and ‘service to Him’.

197 Your scholars do not know the scripture. Among earlier and later injunctions, the later one prevails.[32]

198 Look into your own scripture, consider it carefully, and tell Me plainly what it has written at the end.”

199 The mleccha said, “What You say is true. It is written in the scripture, but no one can accept it.

200 They interpret everything in terms of the impersonal Lord. That the Lord with form is the one to be served — no one knows this.

201 You are that very Lord — God Himself. Be merciful to me; I am an unworthy sinner.

202 I have studied much of the mleccha scriptures, yet I cannot determine what the goal is and what the means.

203 At the sight of You my tongue speaks the name of Kṛṣṇa, and my pride — ‘I am a great scholar’ — is gone.

204 Be merciful and tell me of the goal and the means.” Saying this, he fell at Mahāprabhu’s feet.

205 The Lord said, “Rise. You have taken the name of Kṛṣṇa. The sins of millions of births are gone; you have become pure.”[33]

206 He instructed them, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’! Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’!” Everyone said “Kṛṣṇa”, and all were overwhelmed with love.

207 The Lord gave him the name Rāmadāsa. Another Paṭhān there was named Bijalī Khān.

208 He was young, the son of a king, and Rāmadāsa and the other Paṭhāns were his servants.

209 Crying “Kṛṣṇa!”, he fell at Mahāprabhu’s feet, and the Lord placed His holy foot on his head.

210 Having shown mercy to them all, the Lord went on His way, and those Paṭhāns all became renunciants.

211 They became famous as the ‘Paṭhān Vaiṣṇavas’, and they wandered everywhere singing the glories of Mahāprabhu.

212 That Bijalī Khān became a mahā-bhāgavata, and his greatness was renowned at every holy place.

213 Such are the pastimes of the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Coming to the West, He blessed the yavanas and others.

214 At Soro-kṣetra the Lord bathed in the Gaṅgā, and then He set out for Prayāga by the road along its bank.

215 There the Lord bade farewell to that brāhmaṇa and to Kṛṣṇadāsa, but the two folded their hands and said:

216 "We two will go with You as far as Prayāga. Where shall we ever again find the company of Your feet?

217 This is a land of mlecchas, and someone somewhere may make trouble. The Bhaṭṭācārya is a scholar; he does not know how to talk to them."

218 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled slightly, and the two went on with the Lord.

219 Whoever saw the Lord became mad with love and began the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's names.

220 From them others received it, and from those others still more; in this way He made Vaiṣṇavas of the people of every land and village.

221 Just as He displayed His power when He went to the South, so too He flooded the West with love.[34]

222 Travelling in this way, the Lord came to Prayāga, and for ten days He took the Makara bath at Triveṇī.

223 The Lord's journey to Vṛndāvana and His deeds are endless; even the thousand-mouthed Śeṣa cannot reach their end.

224 Who, being a tiny jīva, could describe them? I have only given a glimpse, setting it down in brief.

225 The Lord's pastimes are extraordinary, and His ways are extraordinary; even hearing of them, the unfortunate do not believe.

226 Know that Caitanya's pastimes are extraordinary from beginning to end. Hear them with faith and accept them as true.

227 Whoever argues about this is a 'king of fools'; he brings a thunderbolt down on his own head.

228 These deeds of Caitanya are an 'ocean of nectar'; a single drop of it floods the world with bliss.

229 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[35]

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
2. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in this way the Lord showed that these two rice fields are Rādhā-kuṇḍa and Śyāma-kuṇḍa. Edition heading: "Gaura, endowed with Rādhā's sentiment and lustre, reveals the hidden Śrī Rādhā-kuṇḍa." ↩
3. The same verse as Ādi 4.215 and Madhya 8.98; translation as there. The edition's heading here: "the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*". ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Sumanaḥ-sarovara is the same as Kusuma-sarovara. ↩
5. The author's own verse (edition heading). *Svasmai* — "to Himself". *Anubhāṣya*: Gaura is Kṛṣṇa's own form; nondifferent from the One He worships, He regards Himself as His servant. ↩
6. According to the *Anubhāṣya*, the gopīs sing this verse: wandering in longing for Kṛṣṇa, they see before them Govardhana, the king of mountains,

nondifferent from Vrajendranandana. ↩

7. The reference follows the edition's heading. ↩
8. Edition heading: "The merciful Gopāla, on some pretext, gives darśana to the devotees." ↩
9. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: wishing to show mercy to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī as well, Gopāla again raised the same "pretext", fear of the mlecchas. *Anubhāṣya*: Viṭhṭhaleśvara (Viṭhṭhalanātha) was the son of Vallabha Bhaṭṭa. ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: this Laghu Haridāsa is not the Choṭa Haridāsa of Mahāprabhu's time, who left his body at Prayāga. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya* (edition heading): in the cave dwell the Deities of Nanda, Yaśodā and Kṛṣṇa. ↩
12. The same verse as Madhya 8.218; translation as there. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord stayed with the disciple of Mādhavendra Purī of whom the previous chapter tells (Madhya 17). ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: this place is now called Āmli-talā (cf. verse 83). ↩
15. The third watch (*prahara*) of the day is the early afternoon; so too the edition's heading ("after midday"). ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: *parateka* means *pratyakṣa*, *sākṣāt* — "before one's very eyes". ↩
17. In the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition the people's words end with verse 106; verses 107–108 are the author's. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: the Māyāvādīs say that on taking the staff a sannyāsī becomes Nārāyaṇa, and they greet such staff-bearers with "Oṁ namo nārāyaṇāya"; but the jīva, liberated or conditioned, is eternally subject to Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of māyā, and must never be called Nārāyaṇa. ↩
19. The source follows the edition's heading: the *Sarvajña-sūkta* as quoted in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha*, or the words of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.7.5–6. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: the *pāṣaṇḍī* is one who regards Śrī Viṣṇu, the Lord of māyā, whose form is pure goodness and consciousness, as one with the jīva subject to māyā or with things made of māyā, or who holds them to be equal. ↩
21. The verse = Madhya 16.186; the translation is the same as there. The heading in the edition confirms the reference. ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the essential characteristic (*svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*) is that by which a thing is known in itself; the indirect one (*taṭastha*), that by which it is known in comparison with other things. The glories the people described are indirect marks; but that, on merely seeing the Lord, one realises

"This is the son of the king of Vraja" — this is His essential characteristic, by which He is recognised as Kṛṣṇa. ↩

23. The second line is the same as in Madhya 17.151. ↩
24. *Anubhāṣya*: *pañcasi* is a corrupt form of *pañcadaśī*, the fifteenth lunar day, the full moon. ↩
25. *Anubhāṣya*: Mahāvana is Gokula. ↩
26. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bāṭoyāra* are those who rob on the roads; *māri' ḍāriyāche* means "they have killed him". ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: a *sikdār* is an officer charged with keeping order, or a military commander. ↩
28. Heading in the edition: the Paṭhān angrily calls them all "robbers". ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: *phukāri* — giving the signal on a horn. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ghoḍā-piḍā* — the horses and what they carry on their backs, the saddles and so on. ↩
30. Heading in the edition: the Lord was not to see enmity shown towards His devotees. ↩
31. Heading in the edition: this man was a *maulānā*, a Muslim divine. ↩
32. Heading in the edition: Muslim scholars generally do not know the true meaning of the Koran; the later injunction, on devotion, is stronger than the earlier injunctions on karma and jñāna. ↩
33. Heading in the edition: even a semblance (*ābhāsa*) of Kṛṣṇa's name had destroyed the heap of his sins. ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya*: some say that the Lord then went from Vṛndāvana to Kurukṣetra and from there to Prayāga; at Kurukṣetra, near the temple of Bhadrakālī, a Deity of Śrī Gaura is present to this day. ↩
35. The verse = Madhya 7.155 (the closing refrain); the translation is the same as there. ↩